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Complete Beginner's Guide: Build Websites with Kimi AI + GitHub + Netlify

Your Journey to Becoming a Website Developer

PART 1: WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW FIRST

What is Kimi AI?

Kimi AI is an artificial intelligence assistant that can write code for you. You tell it what you want your website to look like and do, and it generates the HTML, CSS, and JavaScript code. Think of it as a smart partner that does the heavy coding while you focus on design and ideas.

What is GitHub?

GitHub is a website where you store your code safely online. It is like Google Drive but specifically for code. It keeps track of every change you make, allows you to collaborate with others, and connects to Netlify to automatically deploy your website every time you make changes.

What is Netlify?

Netlify is a service that takes your code from GitHub and turns it into a live website that anyone in the world can visit. You do not need to buy a server or learn complex server management. Netlify does it all for you for free.

What You Will Build

By the end of this guide, you will have: 1. A GitHub account and repository 2. A professional website built with Kimi AI 3. A live website on Netlify with a custom domain 4. The knowledge to update and improve your site anytime

PART 2: SETTING UP YOUR ACCOUNTS

Step 1: Create a GitHub Account

1. Open your web browser and go to github.com
2. Click the green "Sign up" button
3. Enter your email address
4. Create a strong password (use letters, numbers, and symbols)
5. Choose a username (this will be part of your public profile, so pick something professional)
6. Solve the verification puzzle if asked
7. Click "Create account"
8. Check your email for a verification code from GitHub
9. Enter the code on the GitHub website
10. Answer the questions about your experience level (it is okay to say beginner)
11. Click "Complete setup"

Important: Write down your username, email, and password somewhere safe. You will need them often.

Step 2: Create a Netlify Account

1. Open your browser and go to netlify.com
2. Click "Sign up" in the top right corner
3. Choose "Sign up with GitHub" (this is the easiest way)
4. Authorize Netlify to access your GitHub account
5. Click "Authorize Netlify"
6. Fill in your name and click "Continue"
7. You can skip the team setup by clicking "Skip for now"

Your Netlify account is now connected to your GitHub account. This connection is what allows automatic deployment.

Step 3: Set Up Kimi AI Access

1. Open your browser and go to kimi.moonshot.cn (or the Kimi platform you have access to)
 2. Create an account using your email or phone number
 3. Complete the registration process
 4. You are now ready to start asking Kimi AI to write code for you
-

PART 3: CREATING YOUR FIRST WEBSITE WITH KIMI AI

Understanding Website Basics

A website is made of three main technologies: - **HTML** (HyperText Markup Language): The structure and content of your website (text, images, headings, buttons) - **CSS** (Cascading Style Sheets): The design and appearance (colors, fonts, spacing, layout) - **JavaScript**: The interactivity (animations, forms, dynamic content)

Kimi AI can generate all three for you.

Step 4: Plan Your Website

Before asking Kimi AI to code, plan what you want:

1. **What is the purpose of your website?**
 - Business website (show services, contact info)
 - Personal portfolio (show your work)
 - Blog (write articles)
 - E-commerce (sell products)
2. **What sections do you need?**
 - Home page (hero section, about, services)
 - About page
 - Services/Products page
 - Contact page
 - Blog page
3. **What style do you want?**
 - Modern and minimal
 - Bold and colorful
 - Professional and corporate
 - Creative and artistic
4. **What colors?**
 - Pick a primary color (your main brand color)

- Pick a secondary color (for accents)
- Pick a background color

Example Plan: - Purpose: Business website for a web design agency - Sections: Home, Services, Portfolio, Pricing, Contact - Style: Modern, dark theme with gold accents - Colors: Dark navy (#0a0f1a), Gold (#c9a227), White text

Step 5: Ask Kimi AI to Generate Your Website

Here is exactly how to talk to Kimi AI to get the best results:

Prompt Template for Kimi AI:

I want to create a professional website for my [business type].

Here are the details:

- Business name: [Your Business Name]
- What we do: [Short description]
- Location: [Your City, Country]
- Contact: [Phone number], [Email]

I need these pages:

1. Home page with hero section, about us, services, and contact form
2. Services page listing what we offer
3. Contact page with form and map

Design requirements:

- Style: [modern/minimal/bold/professional]
- Primary color: [color code or name]
- Secondary color: [color code or name]
- Must be mobile responsive (works on phones)
- Must have smooth animations
- Must include a navigation menu
- Must have a footer with social links

Please generate the complete HTML, CSS, and JavaScript code for this website. Give me one complete file for the homepage first, and then additional files for other pages.

Example Prompt (Copy and modify):

I want to create a professional website for my web design agency called "NexaFlow Digital".

Here are the details:

- Business name: NexaFlow Digital
- What we do: We create websites, mobile apps, and AI automation for businesses in Kenya
- Location: Nairobi, Kenya
- Contact: +254 106 216 699, support@nexaflow.com

I need these pages:

1. Home page with hero section, services, portfolio, pricing, and contact form
2. Services page with detailed service descriptions
3. Contact page with form and contact info

Design requirements:

- Style: Modern, premium, dark theme
- Primary color: Dark navy #0a0f1a
- Accent color: Gold #c9a227
- Text color: White #f8fafc
- Must be mobile responsive
- Must have smooth scroll animations
- Must include navigation menu with logo
- Must have WhatsApp chat button
- Must have footer with links

Please generate the complete HTML code for the homepage. Include CSS in a style tag and JavaScript in a script tag so it is one complete file.

Step 6: Review and Refine the Code

Kimi AI will give you code. Here is what to check:

1. Does the code have these essential parts?

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Your Page Title</title>
  <style>
    /* CSS styles here */
  </style>
</head>
<body>
  <!-- HTML content here -->
  <script>
    // JavaScript here
  </script>
</body>
</html>
```

2. **Check the title tag** — this is what appears in browser tabs and Google search results

3. **Check that images use URLs** not local paths like `/images/photo.jpg` — for now, use URLs from unsplash.com or similar

4. **If something looks wrong**, tell Kimi AI:

The navigation menu is not sticky when I scroll. Can you fix that?

or

The contact form does not have a submit button. Please add one.

Step 7: Get All Your Pages

After getting the homepage, ask Kimi AI for the other pages:

Now give me the complete code for the Services page. Use the same design style, colors, and navigation as the homepage.

Then:

Now give me the complete code for the Contact page. Include a working contact form.

Save each file with a clear name: - `index.html` (this MUST be your homepage — it is the default page) - `services.html` - `contact.html`

PART 4: STORING YOUR CODE ON GITHUB

Step 8: Create a Repository

A repository (repo) is like a folder on GitHub where your website code lives.

1. Log in to github.com
2. Click the green “+” button in the top right corner
3. Click “New repository”
4. Name your repository: `my-website` (or any name you prefer)
5. Make it “Public” (so Netlify can access it)
6. Check the box that says “Add a README file”
7. Click “Create repository”

Step 9: Upload Your Website Files

Method A: Upload via Web (Easiest for Beginners)

1. In your new repository, click the “Add file” button
2. Click “Upload files”
3. Drag and drop your HTML files (`index.html`, `services.html`, `contact.html`)
4. Scroll down and click “Commit changes”

Method B: Edit Directly on GitHub

1. In your repository, click “Add file”
2. Click “Create new file”
3. Name it `index.html`
4. Paste the code Kimi AI gave you
5. Scroll down and click “Commit new file”
6. Repeat for other pages

Step 10: Organize Your Files

Your repository should look like this:

```
my-website/
├── index.html           (homepage)
├── services.html        (services page)
├── contact.html         (contact page)
├── privacy.html         (privacy policy)
├── README.md            (GitHub automatically created this)
└── images/              (folder for images, optional)
```

To create a folder for images: 1. Click “Add file” → “Create new file” 2. Type: `images/README.md` (this creates the images folder) 3. Type anything in the file 4. Click “Commit new file”

PART 5: DEPLOYING TO NETLIFY (MAKING YOUR SITE LIVE)

Step 11: Connect GitHub to Netlify

1. Go to netlify.com and log in
2. On your dashboard, click “Add new site” → “Import an existing project”
3. Click “GitHub” as your Git provider
4. Authorize Netlify if asked
5. Find and click on your repository (`my-website`)
6. Click “Deploy site”

Netlify will now: - Download your code from GitHub - Process it - Give you a live website URL

This takes about 1-2 minutes.

Step 12: Your Site is Live

1. Netlify will show you a random URL like: `https://happy-fox-123456.netlify.app`
2. Click the URL to see your live website
3. Your website is now accessible to anyone in the world

Step 13: Set a Custom Domain (Optional but Recommended)

Free Netlify Domain: Your site works on the Netlify URL for free forever.

Custom Domain (like `yourname.com`): 1. Buy a domain from a registrar like Namecheap, GoDaddy, or HostPinnacle 2. In Netlify, go to "Site settings" → "Domain management" 3. Click "Add custom domain" 4. Enter your domain name 5. Follow Netlify's DNS instructions (they will guide you) 6. Wait 24-48 hours for the domain to connect

PART 6: CONNECTING A CONTACT FORM

Step 14: Add a Netlify Form

Netlify can handle form submissions for free. Here is how:

1. In your `contact.html`, find the `<form>` tag
2. Change it to:

```
<form name="contact" method="POST" data-netlify="true">
  <input type="text" name="name" placeholder="Your Name" required>
  <input type="email" name="email" placeholder="Your Email" required>
  <textarea name="message" placeholder="Your Message" required></textarea>
  <button type="submit">Send Message</button>
</form>
```

3. The key parts are:

- `name="contact"` (gives the form a name)
- `method="POST"` (sends data securely)
- `data-netlify="true"` (tells Netlify to handle this form)

4. Save the file and commit to GitHub
5. Netlify will automatically update your site
6. Form submissions will appear in your Netlify dashboard under "Forms"

Step 15: Test Your Form

1. Go to your live website
 2. Fill out the contact form
 3. Click submit
 4. Check your Netlify dashboard → “Forms” → “Active forms”
 5. You should see the submission there
-

PART 7: UPDATING YOUR WEBSITE

Step 16: Making Changes

Whenever you want to update your website:

1. Ask Kimi AI for the new code or changes
2. Go to your GitHub repository
3. Find the file you want to edit
4. Click the pencil icon (Edit this file)
5. Make your changes
6. Scroll down and write a brief description of what you changed
7. Click “Commit changes”
8. Netlify automatically detects the change and redeploys your site (takes 1-2 minutes)

Step 17: Adding New Pages

1. Ask Kimi AI to generate a new page (e.g., “Create a Blog page”)
 2. On GitHub, click “Add file” → “Create new file”
 3. Name it (e.g., `blog.html`)
 4. Paste the code
 5. Commit the file
 6. Netlify automatically deploys it
 7. Access it at `your-site.netlify.app/blog.html`
-

PART 8: ADVANCED FEATURES

Adding a Blog

For a simple blog without a database:

1. Create `blog.html` as your blog index page
2. Create individual article files like:
 - `blog/my-first-article.html`
 - `blog/why-websites-matter.html`

3. Link them from your blog index page

For a more advanced blog, consider using a static site generator like Hugo or Jekyll (learn these after you are comfortable with basic HTML).

Adding Google Analytics

1. Go to analytics.google.com
2. Create an account
3. Get your tracking code (looks like G-XXXXXXXXXX)
4. Ask Kimi AI: "Add Google Analytics tracking code G-XXXXXXXXXX to my website"
5. Kimi AI will give you a small script to add before the closing `</head>` tag
6. Add it to all your pages

SEO Basics

For each page, make sure you have:

```
<head>
  <title>Page Title | Your Brand Name</title>
  <meta name="description" content="Brief description of this page (150
characters max)">
  <meta name="keywords" content="keyword1, keyword2, keyword3">
  <link rel="canonical" href="https://your-site.com/page.html">
</head>
```

Ask Kimi AI to generate these for each page.

Adding a Favicon

A favicon is the small icon in the browser tab.

1. Create a square image (32x32 or 64x64 pixels)
2. Convert it to .ico format using a free online converter
3. Name it `favicon.ico`
4. Upload it to your GitHub repository root
5. Add this to your HTML `<head>` :

```
<link rel="icon" type="image/x-icon" href="/favicon.ico">
```

PART 9: COMMON PROBLEMS AND SOLUTIONS

Problem 1: Changes Not Showing on Live Site

Solution: Netlify takes 1-2 minutes to deploy. Wait and refresh. If still not showing, check that you committed the changes to GitHub.

Problem 2: Images Not Loading

Solution: Make sure image URLs are complete (start with https://). If using local images, they must be in your GitHub repository.

Problem 3: Website Looks Different on Phone

Solution: Tell Kimi AI: "Make sure this is mobile responsive. Add media queries for screens smaller than 768px."

Problem 4: Form Submissions Not Working

Solution: Check that your form has `data-netlify="true"`. Make sure you redeployed after adding the form. Test on the live URL, not just locally.

Problem 5: Domain Not Connecting

Solution: DNS changes take 24-48 hours. Double-check that you entered the correct DNS records in your domain registrar.

PART 10: YOUR LEARNING PATH FORWARD

Week 1-2: Get Comfortable

- Build 1-2 simple websites using this guide
- Practice asking Kimi AI for different features
- Learn to read basic HTML and CSS

Week 3-4: Learn the Basics

- Learn what HTML tags do (div, section, h1, p, a, img)
- Learn CSS basics (colors, fonts, margins, padding, flexbox)
- Learn how to use browser developer tools (right-click → Inspect)

Month 2: Expand Your Skills

- Learn JavaScript basics (variables, functions, events)
- Learn how to use a CSS framework like Tailwind CSS
- Build a multi-page website with navigation

Month 3: Professional Level

- Learn about React or Vue.js (modern JavaScript frameworks)
- Learn about responsive design patterns
- Build a portfolio of 3-5 websites

Ongoing: Stay Updated

- Follow web development blogs
 - Join Kenyan tech communities on WhatsApp and Telegram
 - Watch YouTube tutorials
 - Keep experimenting with Kimi AI for new features
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QUICK REFERENCE CHEAT SHEET

Essential Kimi AI Prompts

Generate a complete website:

Create a [type] website for [business name]. Include [list pages]. Use [colors]. Make it mobile responsive.

Add a feature:

Add a [feature name] to my website. Here is my current code: [paste code]

Fix a problem:

This [element] is not [working properly]. Here is the code: [paste code]. Please fix it.

Make it responsive:

Make this website mobile responsive. Add media queries for screens smaller than 768px.

Essential GitHub Actions

Action	How
Upload file	Click “Add file” → “Upload files”
Edit file	Click file → Click pencil icon
Create new file	Click “Add file” → “Create new file”
Create folder	Create file with name <code>foldername/README.md</code>
View history	Click “Commits” at top of repo

Essential Netlify Actions

Action	How
See deployed site	Click the URL on your dashboard
View form submissions	Dashboard → Forms → Active forms
Add custom domain	Site settings → Domain management
Check deploy status	Click on your site → Deploys tab
Redeploy manually	Click “Trigger deploy”

FINAL CHECKLIST: BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ GitHub account created
- ☐ Netlify account created (linked to GitHub)
- ☐ Kimi AI access ready
- ☐ Website plan written down (purpose, pages, colors)
- ☐ Business information ready (name, contact, description)
- ☐ Images selected (or plan to use Unsplash URLs)

REMEMBER

1. **Start simple.** Your first website does not need to be perfect.
2. **Ask Kimi AI for help constantly.** That is what it is for.
3. **Commit to GitHub often.** Every time you make a change, commit it.
4. **Test on your phone.** Always check how your site looks on mobile.
5. **Google is your friend.** If you get stuck, search for the error message.
6. **Be patient.** Learning takes time, but each website you build makes you faster.
7. **Show your work.** Share your websites with friends and ask for feedback.

You now have everything you need to start building professional websites. Go create something amazing!

Guide created for aspiring web developers in Kenya and beyond. Tools: Kimi AI, GitHub, Netlify Cost to start: FREE